Build Your Portfolio with AI

Using Claude to Create a Full-Stack Website

70-Minute Hands-On Workshop

> Transform Your Ideas into a Live Portfolio in Just Minutes

This workshop is designed for aspiring web developers and creative professionals looking to showcase their skills through an AI-powered portfolio website.

What We'll Build Today

Modern Portfolio Site

- Hero section with your name
- About me section
- Project showcase (3 projects)
- Contact information

Single-File Design

- Embedded CSS styling
- Built-in JavaScript
- Responsive & mobile-friendly
- Ready to deploy instantly

Workshop Agenda

10 min - Introduction & Demo

Kickoff with project overview and live demonstration of key features to establish context.

15 min - Hands-On Build

Guided practical session where participants implement core functionality with instructor support.

15 min - Deploy & Share

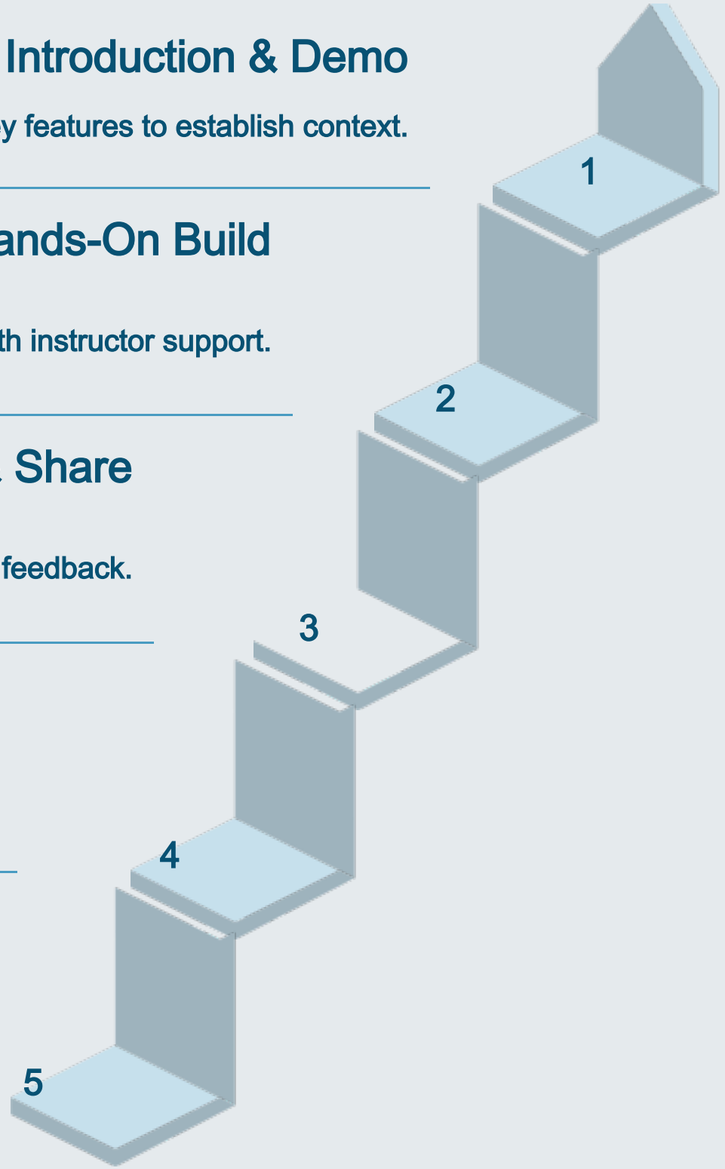
Finalize projects and publish results for peer review and collaborative feedback.

25 min - Customization

Participants personalize their builds with advanced configurations and optional modules.

5 min - Q&A

Open forum to address remaining questions and discuss implementation best practices.



90 Minutes Total - Comprehensive workshop covering all phases from concept to deployment.

Why Claude?

Fast Results

Go from idea to working website in minutes, not hours with Claude's rapid prototyping capabilities that accelerate your development cycle significantly.

No Coding Required

Write in plain English and get professional code output without needing any programming expertise or technical background knowledge.

Easy Iterations

Ask for changes naturally using conversational language and see instant results as Claude implements modifications in real-time.

Learn as You Go

Understand the code Claude creates for you through detailed explanations that enhance your technical knowledge progressively.

Before We Start: What You Need

Access to Claude.ai

Free account at claude.ai

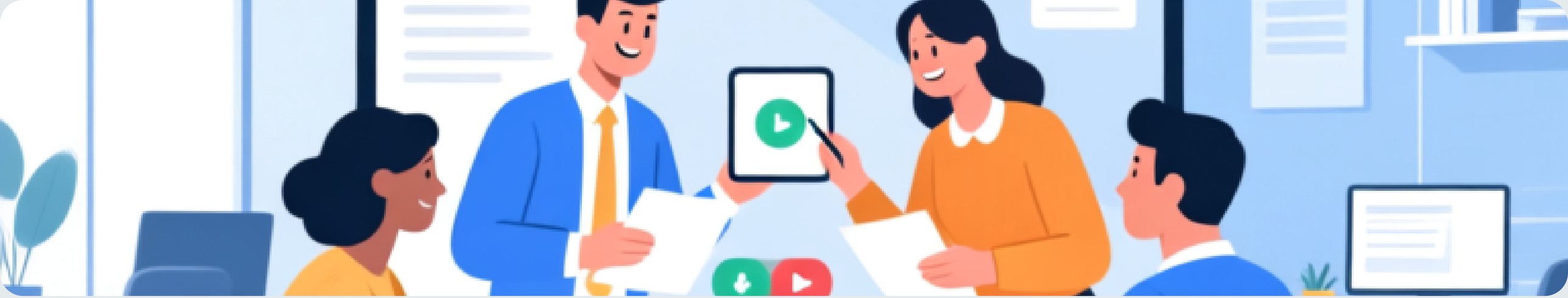
Your Personal Info Ready

Bio, projects, contact details

A Web Browser

Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge

Everything else is included in this workshop!



Live Demo

Watch me create a functional portfolio website in just 2-3 prompts! You'll witness the full power of AI-assisted development from start to finish.

1 Real-time AI Response

See immediate code generation as I type each prompt, with Claude processing requests and delivering solutions instantly.

2 Instant Preview

Watch the website come to life before your eyes as we toggle between code editor and live browser preview.

Get ready to take notes - this will be fast! Keep Claude.ai open in another window to follow along and experiment with your own variations.

Checklist

- OPEN: https://claude.ai/
- Create a free account and open the chatbox

Claude

Your Starting Prompt: The Complete Template

Structured Prompt Example

Create a modern, responsive personal portfolio website with:

- Hero section with my name and title
- About section with biography
- Projects showcase (3 projects with descriptions)
- Contact section with email/links
- Make it a single HTML file with embedded CSS and JavaScript
- Use a clean, professional design with modern aesthetics

Pro Tips

Be specific about:

- Color preferences [e.g. "use navy blue and gold accent colors"]
- Style preferences [e.g. "minimalist with geometric elements"]
- Include your actual information in brackets [e.g. "John Doe, Frontend Developer"]

Key Benefits of This Structure: Clear sectioning, specific technical requirements, visual style guidance, and bracketed placeholders ensure you get exactly what you need while allowing flexibility for the designer's creativity.

Your Turn! You Have 15 Minutes

Don't worry - we're here to help if you get stuck!

Save your code as you go!

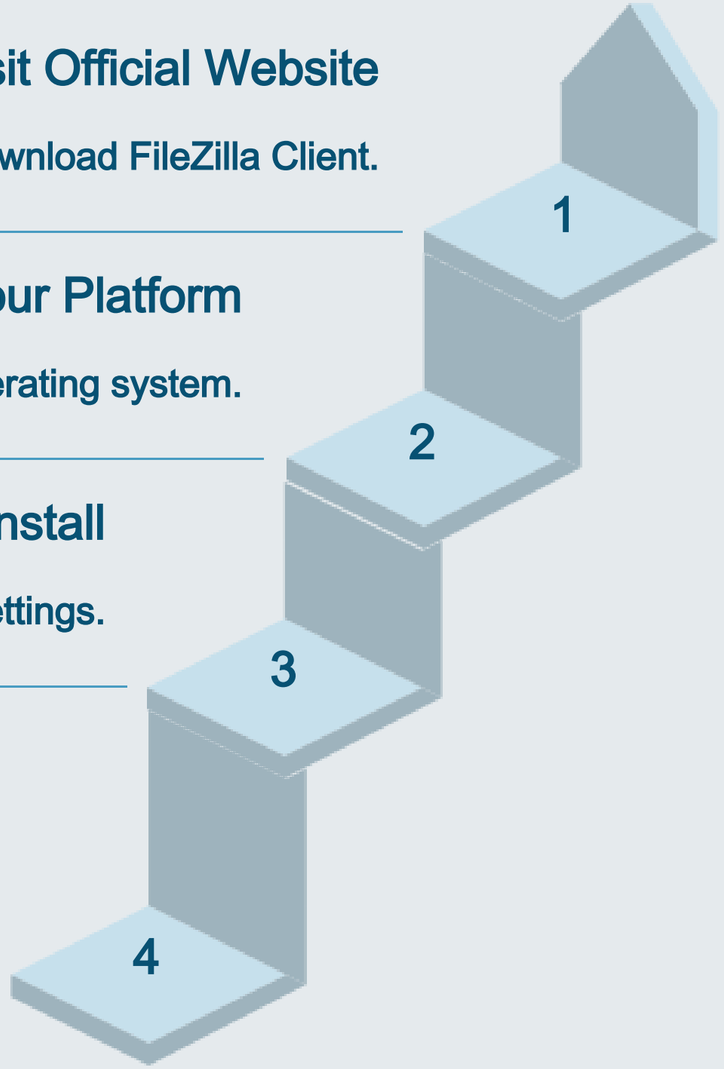
Get Your Site Online: Download FileZilla

FileZilla free and take less than 2 minutes to set up!

Zorak - MU Hosting Site

- Download FileZilla
- Create an account
- Connect to the Hosting Server
  - Host: zorak.monmouth.edu
  - Username: s'monmouthID'
  - Port: 21
- Move & drop files in server
- Run the URL - http://zorak.monmouth.edu/~sXXXXXXX/

Download FileZilla: Step-by-Step Guide



Visit Official Website

Go to filezilla-project.org and click Download FileZilla Client.

Select Your Platform

Choose Windows or macOS version based on your operating system.

Download & Install

Run the installer and follow the setup wizard with default settings.

Launch Application

Open FileZilla and you're ready to connect to your hosting server.

Troubleshooting: Common Issues & Quick Fixes

Too much text

Problem: Content appears overly verbose or detailed beyond requirements. Solution: Ask Claude to be more concise by specifying desired word count or bullet point format.

Colors don't match

Problem: Visual elements use incompatible or undesired color combinations. Solution: Request specific color schemes or provide exact hex codes for primary/secondary colors.

Layout looks off

Problem: Structural elements appear misaligned or improperly spaced. Solution: Revise specific sections only with clear positioning instructions rather than regenerating entire code.

Need to add content

Problem: Existing framework requires supplemental information or sections. Solution: Add new components incrementally with focused requests to maintain structural integrity.

Take It Further: Customization Ideas

Try these prompts to customize your portfolio:

Color Scheme Update

Make the color scheme purple and teal with gradients to create a modern and vibrant visual identity that stands out from standard portfolios.

Interactive Animations

Add smooth scroll animations and hover effects to create engaging micro-interactions that delight visitors and showcase technical skills.

Project Display

Change projects to card-based layouts with consistent dimensions and hover states for better visual organization and professional presentation.

Social Proof

Add a testimonials section featuring client feedback and endorsements to build credibility and demonstrate real-world impact.

Dark Mode

Integrate a dark mode toggle that automatically follows system preferences while allowing manual override for user comfort.

Depth Effects

Add parallax scrolling effects to create dimensional movement that makes the portfolio feel dynamic and contemporary.

The possibilities are endless - let your creativity guide you!

Iteration Best Practices: The Art of Refinement

Be Specific

Point to exact sections you want changed. Instead of vague requests like 'make it better', provide concrete instructions such as 'make the hero text larger and add a gradient background'. This clarity helps implement precise modifications.

One Change at a Time

Multiple simultaneous changes can confuse Claude. Build gradually from a working version by implementing one modification at a time. This sequential approach ensures stability and makes troubleshooting easier.

Save Versions

Download your file after each major change so you can rollback if needed. Version control prevents losing working iterations and allows comparison between different stages of refinement.

Pro Tip: Keep a change log of all modifications for easy tracking. Document each change with its date and purpose to maintain a clear history of your refinement process.

What's Next? Your Portfolio Journey Continues

Expand Your Site

- Add a blog section to showcase your thought leadership and expertise
- Include client testimonials to build credibility and social proof
- Create detailed project pages with case studies and outcomes
- Build contact forms to make it easy for potential clients to reach you
- Add downloadable resume for recruiters and hiring managers

Deepen Your Skills

- Explore prompt engineering best practices for more efficient development
- Try building other site types like landing pages and blogs to diversify your portfolio
- Learn HTML/CSS fundamentals to gain more control over your designs
- Experiment with frameworks like React or Vue to expand your technical capabilities

Build Your Brand

- Update portfolio monthly with new projects and improvements
- Contribute to open source to demonstrate your coding skills
- Share your learning journey on social media to establish your online presence
- Network with other developers to learn and find collaboration opportunities
- Create project documentation to showcase your attention to detail

We've provided an advanced prompts handout with templates for next-level creation to help you implement these growth strategies effectively.

Thank You For Building Today!

Interactive Engagement

Questions? Feedback? Let's discuss - we're here to help with anything you'd like to refine.

Questions & Live Sharing Time - Please share your portfolio links and ask your questions! We'd love to see what you've created.

Celebration

Congratulations! You've just created your first AI-powered portfolio. You've learned how to communicate with AI, iterate on designs, and deploy real projects - these are highly valued skills.

Inspiration

You've just taken your first step into the future of web development. Keep building!

Technology Evaluation Su

Your Feedback Matters

Help us improve future workshops by sharing your experience today. Your insights about the pacing, content clarity, and overall learning experience are invaluable for enhancing our curriculum.

This 5-minute survey covers workshop effectiveness, content quality, and suggestions for improvement. Your responses help us create better learning experiences for future participants.
Link:
https://forms.office.com/Pages/ResponsePage.aspx?id=VvuY0_AbSkySIU0Tj6cmU0IDCrO9K51DlrPrrxIUUIJUQUxFWlJTWTRBWDRXMk1DV0lWN1lPTjJWTC4u